SUMMARIES AND ABSTRACTS/INSTRUCTIONS

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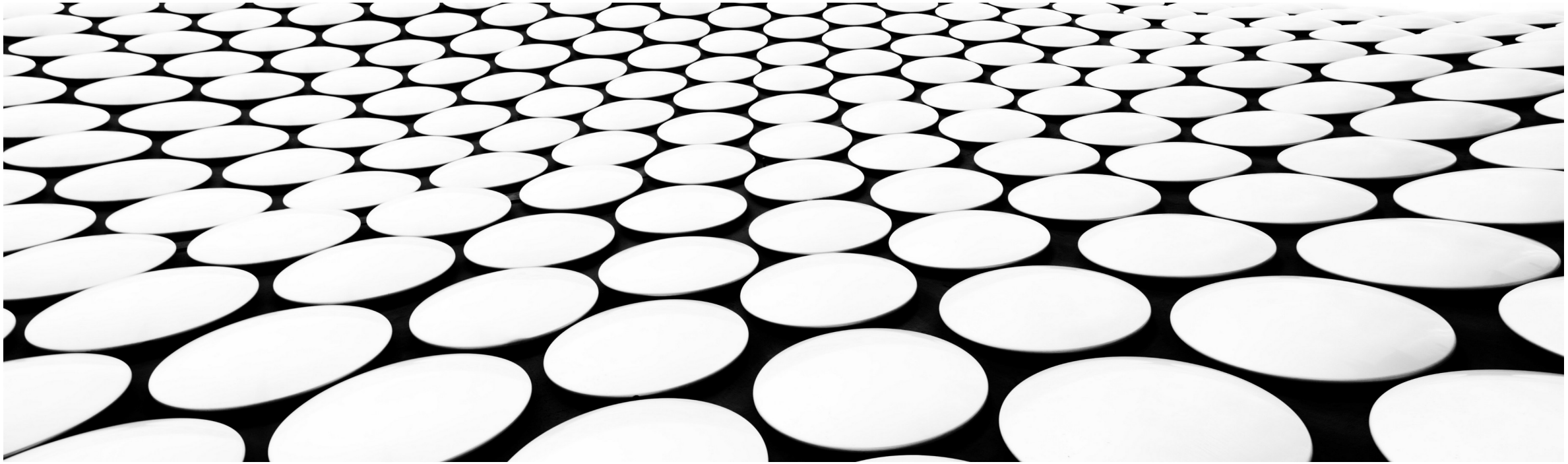

A LIL HOUSEKEEPING

- **Exams have not been graded yet.**
- **We need to discuss the revised calendar this week.**
- **We are covering Instructions, a wee assignment due 3/19.**
- **We are covering Summaries and Abstracts, due by 3/21.**

FINDING A READING ASSIGNMENT FOR SUMMARY/ABSTRACT

WHAT ARE YOUR OPTIONS???

AN ARTICLE THAT RELATES TO YOUR CURRENT JOB OR MAJOR

AN ARTICLE FROM A SCHOLARLY SOURCE!

- Scholarly sources appear in peer reviewed academic journals.
- They are written by authors who are dedicated to their profession, not journalists.
- They are not easily accessible for most people.
- They contain no ads.
- There is a broad range of topics.
- Written for a very specific audience.
- Find in the Bierce Library System for free.
- Primary source

TRADE PUBLICATION

- Written by journalists with industry insight…not your average journalist.
- Not widely available in print.
- Written for an audience with more of a business mindset.
- Covers a wide variety of topics in a wide variety of industries.
- Google will be a good place to start.
- My brother, Mike, has worked in trade publication writing/editing and even management for years.
- Who knows, maybe you will use one of his articles.
- Secondary source

POPULAR SOURCE ARTICLE

- Wide variety of topics
- Easily accessible
- Written by journalists
- Geared towards a mass audience
- Search engines are a great place to start
- This includes news publications and magazines
- Lots of advertising.

SUMMARY

- A summary is about 5 sentences.
- Intended to give the audience a sneak preview of what the source is about.
- It is NOT a complete overview of the source.
- It should offer insight on approaches, methods, and outcomes.
- It is not meant to be a substitute for reading the actual source itself.
- Think short and simple (around 100 words).
- Single spaced format.

ABSTRACT

- More serious and scholarly.
- Think of it as a condensed version of the source.
- Has a strict word range of about 200-300 words.
- More technical and highly detailed.
- Must use an objective approach.
- Use a single-spaced format.

DON’T FORGET…

- You will need to cite the sourc
- APA and MLA are acceptable.
- However, never mix the formatting; pick one or the other…and stick with it.

APA ARTICLE CITATION EXAMPLE

Journal Article Reference List Format

Structure:
Author, A. A., & Author, B. B. (Year). Title of article. *Title of Journal, Volume*(Issue), Pages. https://doi.org/xx.xxx/xxxx

Example:
McCauley, S. M., & Christiansen, M. H. (2019). Language learning as language use: A cross-linguistic model of child language development. *Psychological Review, 126*(1), 1–51. https://doi.org/10.1037/rev000012

MLA ARTICLE CITATION EXAMPLE

- Bagchi, Alaknanda. "Conflicting Nationalisms: The Voice of the Subaltern in Mahasweta Devi's *Bashai Tudu*." *Tulsa Studies in Women's Literature,* vol. 15, no. 1, 1996, pp. 41-50.

QUESTIONS…

INSTRUCTIONS

- Writing instructions requires a process in itself, or a series of steps.
- You may be required initially to research the process you document that someone else perform and ensure that a user understands it.
- Be sure to plan your steps by knowing your purpose, the tools/parts required, the steps to follow in the correct order, intended outcomes, and any potential risks.
- Performing a trial run of your instructions is also more of a guarantee that they are clear and easy to understand and follow.

INSTRUCTIONS CONTINUED…

- As a writer of instructions, you will also need to provide visuals that are clear and effective, as many people are visual learners.
- A visual should help a reader do a task more quickly and efficiently, so aim for clear, labeled drawings and photos that are sized appropriately and located near the steps they illustrate.
- Always number each figure and refer to it in your set of instructions

INSTRUCTIONS ON INSTRUCTIONS

- Write a brief, concise set of instructions for one (1) of the following.
- Please set it up in M**emorandum format (No more than 2-3 pages).**
- **1. Online banking or bill pay.**
- 2. Creating a blog or social media.
- 3. Logging onto your college library's website
- 5. Accurately collecting a specimen or lab sample
- 6. Creating a slideshow of digital photos
- 7. Jumping a dead car battery or changing a flat tire
- 8. Editing digital video
- OTHER. Run it past me first.
- 9. Instructions related to what you described and defined.

KEYS TO THE GAME

- Instruction writing is MULTI-MODAL.
- MODES of writing are also known as GENRES.
- Let us consider the modes we will be using for this assignment.

MODES AKA GENRES OF WRITING

ARGUMENT

EXAMPLE

NARRATIVE

COMPARE AND CONTRAST

DEFINITION

DESCRIPTION

CLASSIFICATION

PROCESS ANALYSIS

CAUSE AND EFFECT

MORE ABOUT PROCESS ANALYSIS

- DIRECTIVE: Literally giving directions.
- The PRIMARY SUB-MODE here.
- A “How to” approach in a step-by-step format.
- Complete with the appropriate time order transitions.

EXPLANATORY

- Not giving directions but offering explanations for how/why something works a certain way.
- This will not be the SECONDARY SUB-MODE of writing.
- These explanations really offer the audience a complete understanding of the topic/task.
- *Sometimes you have to stop the process to emphasize how/why a step is important and offer details.*

EXPOSITION?

- This is another way of saying background information or extra details.
- In order to stress the importance of the instructions you are giving, share some background information.
- EXPOSITION should not take up too much space.
- Make this brief, interesting, and relevant.
- Opening or closing paragraphs are great places for it.

THE END